Strata lets gaming PCs run AI model locally

Strata is an open source inference engine that allows the 125-billion-parameter Qwen3.8-Flash-Next AI model to run on consumer gaming PCs. The project supports Windows and Linux systems with compatible Nvidia or AMD graphics cards and is designed to keep AI processing on the user's machine rather than sending data to a remote server. Strata is released under the MIT licence, while the model files and some third-party components retain their respective licences.

The project addresses one of the main challenges of running large AI models locally: memory requirements. Strata distributes the workload across the GPU, system RAM and processor, allowing hardware with 12GB or more of VRAM and at least 32GB of RAM to run the model. It uses a mixture-of-experts approach in which the model contains 24,576 experts, but only 10 are required for each word. The system keeps frequently used experts on the graphics card while storing the complete set in system RAM, with the processor handling additional computation.

By combining model compression, GPU-RAM sharing and local inference, Strata provides developers with an open implementation for experimenting with large AI models on consumer hardware rather than depending entirely on cloud-based inference.



Needle is deliberately narrow in what it accepts. If a request does not correspond to any of the available tools, the model can return an empty function-call list rather than attempting to answer it as a conventional language model.



The model can also be fine-tuned locally for a particular collection of tools, making it suitable for dedicated embedded applications with a defined set of actions. Needle 2's weights and code are available under the Apache 2.0 licence, with the model hosted on Hugging Face and the software on GitHub. The combination of a small model, CPU-only execution and local function calling provides a way to add natural-language control to Raspberry Pi projects without sending commands to a remote AI service.

Xiaomi releases MiMo-V2.6 AI models

Xiaomi has released MiMo-V2.6, an open-weight AI model family that includes MiMo-V2.6-Pro-RL, MiMo-V2.6-Flash-RL and MiMo-V2.6-Distill-Qwen-9B. Alongside the model weights, Xiaomi has published more than 7000 reinforcement-learning environments and an end-to-end framework covering environment interaction, trajectory collection, reward evaluation, and policy optimisation. The Pro, Flash, and 9B model repositories list the MIT licence.



The Pro model is positioned as the flagship multimodal model and supports text, image, video, and audio inputs, with a context window of up to 1 million tokens. Flash targets a more efficiency-focused configuration. The 9B model serves a different purpose: Xiaomi describes MiMo-V2.6-Distill-Qwen-9B as a supervised fine-tuned checkpoint based on Qwen3.5-9B and intended as a starting point for reinforcement-learning research.

The release provides developers with three distinct assets rather than simply different sizes of the same model. Pro and Flash are large RL-trained models intended for direct use, while the 9B checkpoint is aimed at further experimentation with agentic reinforcement learning. Public Hugging Face repositories make the model weights available, while the accompanying environments and training framework provide additional material for researchers investigating how reinforcement learning can be applied to AI agents.

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